



Counting Happiness

BSG Statistics Department Monthly Newsletter



HAPPINESS COUNTER



Youth Division

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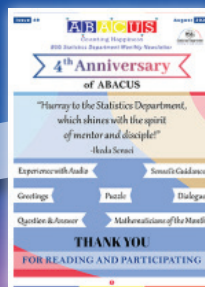
All India

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5th

Anniversary Issue

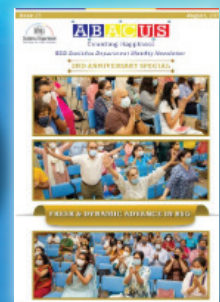
2024



2023



2022



2021



2020





Dear Mathematicians of Happiness,

Heartiest congratulations to each one of you on the joyful occasion of 5th anniversary of ABACUS! This is a truly significant milestone—a celebration of your sincere efforts, unity, and the vibrant spirit of the BSG Statistics Department.

ABACUS was envisioned as your very own newsletter—a shared platform to encourage one another with inspiring experiences, joyful breakthroughs, and practical learnings. Today, I feel deeply proud and confident in saying that ABACUS has grown into a **vital cornerstone** of the Statistics Department, strengthening our mission of **“Cherishing each life”**.

Every edition of ABACUS has carried something special—be it a hopeful guidance from Sensei, a moving experience, a new learning, an encouraging voice from a fellow statistics incharge or be it your exclusive section, “Mathematicians of the Month”. Many of you have shared how reading ABACUS has become a monthly moment of joy—something you look forward to with great anticipation. Few rush to read the experiences, others head straight to the puzzle page (and yes, many secretly check if their name is among the victorious comrades!). In these pages, we find not just content, but connection—reminders that we are part of a shared journey, supporting one another across districts, chapters,

regions, zones and areas.

This month also holds a special place in our hearts—August 24th, the day Ikeda Sensei joined the Soka Gakkai. He wrote about his joining Soka Gakkai and in appreciation to those who introduced him to Toda Sensei in his essay “The Vow of August 24th”:

“I fondly remember with deep gratitude those individuals who spoke to Mr. Toda about me... I think of their earnest prayers and dedication, as well as the sincerity of everyone else involved in enabling the new person to begin practising.” (Golden Pillars of Soka, p. 54)

As we welcome many new lives into BSG, let us take forward Sensei’s guidance with fresh determination. Toward the goal of 1 million BSG members by 2030, your role becomes ever more significant – in taking care of these new lives. I can already imagine future issues of ABACUS echoing with stories of new friends whose lives were transformed because you cared, you cherished them.

Three cheers to all of you!

Three cheers to your noble efforts!

Three cheers to ABACUS!

Warm Regards,

Vishesh Gupta ★★

BSG STATISTICS DEPARTMENT MOTTO

“With the heart of oneness of mentor and disciple, we cherish each life as Bodhisattva of the Earth and strive diligently towards the dynamic and eternal advancement of Kosen-rufu.”



ETERNAL GUIDELINE FOR THE STATISTICS DEPARTMENT

“A membership card is not a piece of paper; it is the life of one person. In it, the life pulsates, the personality is contained, and the drama of awakening in faith and rebirth is played out. There exist the human-to-human bonds of warm trust. Because we have been cherishing each person to the utmost, we see the magnificent development of the Soka Gakkai today.”

- Daisaku Ikeda (December 15, 2002)

PRESIDENT MAKIGUCHI TREASURED EACH INDIVIDUAL

Recounting the efforts made by President Makiguchi, who treasured each individual and, despite his advanced age, readily traveled long distances to share the Mystic Law with even one person, President Ikeda underscores the original spirit of the Soka Gakkai.

Mr. Makiguchi declared: “What is the social *raison d’être* of religion apart from working for the happiness of humanity and making the world a better place?”

Religion has meaning only when it is dedicated to the welfare of individuals, the people, and society. To be satisfied merely with one’s own well-being or salvation, while ignoring the suffering of others, is not the mark of a genuine faith.

Nichiren Buddhism is a teaching dedicated to realizing happiness and peace for all humanity.

As a result of Mr. Makiguchi’s continued efforts to spread the Daishonin’s teachings, the membership of the Soka Kyoiku Gakkai (Value-Creating Education Society; forerunner of the Soka Gakkai) began to increase steadily from around 1940. This came about because he adopted a revolutionary approach to spreading Nichiren Buddhism. He focused on visiting one home after another, speaking to one individual after another. That is the only way to do it, the way it must be done, he concluded.

Mr. Makiguchi, a great scholar, at first hoped that his writings would be an effective means of propagation, but they were not. Then, he tried speaking to large groups at lectures and meetings. That, too, proved ineffective. Books were no good, big meetings were no good. So he set out on his own to meet one individual after another. This led him to the conclusion that “the only way is to find a few like-minded friends.”

After that, propagation advanced significantly. Capable individuals gradually began to emerge. Previously, he had spoken to thousands at large gatherings, but hardly anyone who joined continued practicing. With his new approach, however, the membership soon increased to the point that more than 500 people attended each general meeting.

Through conversations at discussion meetings and other small gatherings, individuals gained understanding and conviction in the validity of Nichiren Buddhism. They then exerted themselves in Buddhist practice and personally experienced the benefit of faith in their lives. This, in turn, brought in a fresh wave of new members.

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Mr. Makiguchi always took an experimental approach, putting his ideas to the test. He tried things out for himself in order to find the best course. He was a truly extraordinary person. I can see why Mr. Toda was so devoted to him.

Mr. Makiguchi also readily went anywhere to meet with even a single individual. Once, he traveled all the way to Kagoshima [in Kyushu, Japan's southwesternmost main island] to meet and speak with the parents of a young man who had joined the Soka Kyoiku Gakkai in Tokyo. It was an extremely long journey by third-class train car, and it must have been very hard on a man of his advanced age. But for the sake of Buddhism, he was prepared to spare no pains. Through his great sincerity, he was able to deepen the parents' understanding of Nichiren Buddhism.

It was actually during one such trip, to Suzaki in Shimoda [in Shizuoka Prefecture] to speak with one individual, that he was arrested.

Many were inspired to join the Soka Kyoiku Gakkai and start practicing Nichiren Buddhism because of Mr. Makiguchi's vibrant, youthful voice, his absolute conviction, and his example of sincerity and compassion.

The roots that Mr. Makiguchi had planted throughout Japan were not eradicated by the militarist authorities' harsh wartime policy of thought control. They survived the war and lived on. Today, the Soka Gakkai has grown from those roots into a great towering tree, unshaken by anything. It has become a global organization. I'm sure Mr. Makiguchi would be delighted to see this.

- *The Wisdom for Creating Happiness and Peace – Part 3*
Kosen-rufu and World Peace, p. 96-98 ★★

Save The Date

**ZONE LEVEL
STATISTICS
INCHARGES
MEETING**

**MONDAY,
25 AUGUST 2025**





WHEN PRAYER MEETS ACTION, VICTORY FOLLOWS

Tunir Saha

***Region Statistics Incharge
East India Area***



Scan to listen to
the experience

I have been striving as a region statistics incharge for the past three years.

After the pandemic, one of the biggest challenges we faced was a drop in attendance, both in Gosho and discussion meetings. Many members were hesitant to come out of their comfort zone, there was a noticeable lack of joy and communication, and some of our district and chapter statistics incharges stopped responding. In a few places, there were no DSIs at all, as they had moved

out of the region. This led to delays in attendance marking and sometimes even incomplete data. Personally at work, my schedule became so hectic that I found it difficult to attend weekday meetings, and at times even the ones on weekends.

Sensei writes, **"The first thing is to pray. From the moment we begin to pray, things start moving. The darker the night, the closer the dawn. From the moment we chant daimoku with a deep and powerful resolve, the**

sun begins to rise in our hearts. "
(Faith into Action, p. 125) Basing my life on this guidance, I made a deep determination to never be defeated, and to make every moment count. I began chanting daimoku with a strong prayer for the happiness, growth, and victory of every single member in BDS. I prayed to connect with each statistics incharge in the region and then took action. We started meeting every alternate month at the chapter, region, or zone level. We studied Sensei's guidance for statistics incharges together and carefully planned our activities.

We ensured that every statistics incharge visited their respective chapters and districts with updated member details in hand. This led to a rise in home visits and strengthened communication between district and chapter leaders. I stayed in constant touch with all statistics incharges, chanting with them, helping them solve database issues, reminding them to mark attendance before freezing date, and encouraging members to subscribe to VC and FDT. I also ensured timely updates, transfers, graduations, and helped new friends get connected to their local districts with the shared spirit to leave no one behind.

Every month, before attendance freezing, we held coordinated calls with all the statistics incharges in the region, to solve any statistics or BDS related queries. These collective efforts led to a powerful transformation in our region. Attendance in discussion and Gosho meetings grew from just

45 and 26 in January 2024, to 237 for discussion meetings in May 2024 and 147 for Gosho Meetings in January 2025. Also, from Jan 2024 to Mar 2025, we have welcomed 120 new friends to our region.

We saw an incredible rise in members sharing victories, a greater sense of joy, and statistics incharges marking attendance on the same day of meetings, with a renewed sense of responsibility. At my workplace, I was able to win the trust of my teammates and reported victories.

However, at the start of this year, I hit a career deadlock. The project I was part of ended. And I found myself at a standstill—without direction, and with very limited opportunities in my current field. In that moment, I further strengthened my faith. Since January 2025, I have chanted 230 hours of daimoku, strove actively as a statistics incharge during the March 16th and May 3rd campaigns, conducted over 50 home visits, engaged in 5 heartfelt dialogues, and successfully did 2 shakubuku.

With utmost faith in the Gohonzon and Sensei in my heart, I have now taken the next step in my career—to pursue regular MBA and have secured admission into a reputed college in Kolkata, finally fulfilling a long-standing dream.

To repay my debt of gratitude to the Mystic Law, I'm even more determined to take the lead in advancing kosen-rufu as a statistics incharge, and to fight every day as the foremost disciple of Ikeda Sensei. ★★



Timely attendance marking is an expression of reporting victory to Ikeda Sensei by statistics incharges!

Introducing the zones where all the districts marked the 'Discussion Meeting' attendance in the month of July 2025

We accord these zones as 'MATHEMATICIANS OF THE MONTH' for July 2025.

MATHEMATICIANS OF THE MONTH

Delhi - East

Ananda – Lotus
Expressway – Jaypee
Ghaziabad
Greno West
Indirapuram
Noida – Vasundhara
Noida City Centre
Noida West

Delhi - North

Ashoka
Central Pitampura
Delhi University
Mansarovar – Naraina
Model Town – Chatrasal
Paschim Vihar – Punjabi Bagh
Pusa
Rajouri
Rohini

Delhi - South

Badkal – Faridabad
CR Park – Kalkaji
Charmwood
Hauz Khas
Kailash
Lodhi Garden
New Friends Colony
Saket

East India

Central Kolkata
Dumdum
Howrah
Odisha North 1
Odisha North 2
Salt Lake-Himalayan
South Central
Tolly Jadavpur – Bihar
Upper Assam

North India

Amritsar
Chandigarh
Jaipur Midtown
Jammu
Lucknow
Lucknow – Gorakhpur
Mansarovar
Mohali
Panchkula West
Rajasthan North

South India

AP – Telangana (North)
Bangalore South Central
Bangalore South East
Bangalore South West
Chennai Central
Chennai East
Chennai West

Delhi - West

Aravali
DLF 1 & 3
DLF 2 & 4
Dwarka – Palam
Dwarka – Uttam Nagar
Epicentre
Golf Course
Janak Puri
Nirvana
Palam Vihar
SBTG
Shanti Path
Sohna
Vasant Kunj East
Vasant Kunj West
Vikasपुरi

West India - 1

Andheri East
Baner – Central
Baroda
Goregaon Malad West
Kandivali East Dahisar
Koregaon – Airport
Magarpatta – Kharadi
Mira Virar
Mulund Ghatkopar
Nasik – Aurangabad
Powai
Pune South 1
Pune South Hills
Surat
Thane – Kalyan

West India - 2

Bandra
Chembur – Ghatkopar
Gateway
Goa
Juhu Link – Yari Road
Juhu Vile Parle
Khar Santacruz BKC
Navi Mumbai
New Mhada Amboli
Sion Parel
Tardeo Malabar

2nd Aug 2025

Young Lions Meeting

**Region Statistics
Incharge** to mark
the attendance



3rd Aug 2025

Gosho Study Meeting

**District Statistics
Incharge** to mark
the attendance



**MEETINGS
IN AUGUST
2025**

31st Aug 2025

Discussion Meeting

**District Statistics
Incharge** to mark
the attendance



Let's promptly mark the attendance of the above meetings and report victory as statistics incharges!



To mark our 5th anniversary, we asked some of our readers:

"Why do you read ABACUS?"

Here's what they had to say — honest, heartfelt, and full of joy!

I read ABACUS to renew my pledge to my mentor as a statistics incharge. And to solve the puzzle which I find very interesting.

- Dr Sujata Garg, CSI, Delhi-NCR

I read ABACUS because Sensei's guidance and experience section remind me of my crucial responsibility as a statistics incharge. It is like a monthly reminder of my determination. And of course, I love the puzzle and first thing I check is if my name is under victorious comrades.

- Kareshma Khanna, DSI, Lucknow

ABACUS is my monthly *awakening* — reminding me that serving as a statistics incharge is a profound way to support our organisation and members. Reading ABACUS rekindles within me the selfless spirit of my mentor, Ikeda Sensei.

- Kamal Sadana, ZSI, Delhi

**Why
do you
read
ABACUS?**

ABACUS encourages me to nurture each life on BDS. Kosen-rufu can only be achieved when the statistics incharges work unitedly and diligently, following Sensei's guidance word to word and ABACUS is a guide towards same.

- Sneha Lohiya, DSI, Delhi

I read ABACUS to deepen my appreciation for our collective progress and to gain fresh perspectives on contributing more meaningfully to the advancement of kosen-rufu.

- Kailash Gajare, DSI, Pune

Every month I read ABACUS and wait for the new issue! It helps me in understanding BDS, encourages me through Sensei's guidance & the experiences, and the most exciting part is puzzle.

- Rajani Bahadure, CSI, Nagpur

ABACUS helps me in strengthening my determination for Kosen-rufu through Sensei's guidance. Also, I am encouraged by the experiences and look forward to gain knowledge through 'Q&A' and 'Do You Know' section.

- Mayank Talwar, RSI, Delhi-NCR

I read the current and past issues of ABACUS mainly for the "Q&A" section which explains the process of using key BDS modules.

- Ramgopal Ramachandran, CSI, Delhi

ABACUS helps me in being more friendly with BDS. I love to solve the puzzle and learn from Sensei's guidance to take care of each individual.

- Bharati Dash, RSI, Cuttack

I read ABACUS to go back to Sensei — the source of my spiritual sustenance. Through ABACUS, I have learnt that each life is precious and has a story to tell.

- Aradhana Jain, DSI, Mumbai



ABACUS Editorial Team, in conversation with

Tanvi Gulati

Zone Statistics Incharge, North Delhi Area



Please share your journey of being a statistics incharge? Also, if you would like to share any success story?

When I was appointed as YWD zone chief, I also joyfully took up the opportunity to work as a zone statistics incharge. I began reaching out to all my statistics incharges, supported them, did follow ups and helped them in getting used to the BDS. Wherever there were no district statistics incharge, I encouraged the chapter and district leaders to identify and appoint someone, so that attendance could be diligently marked and no life is left behind.

Now we have district statistics incharges in almost all districts. And the momentum has picked up

so beautifully that the statistics incharges themselves are marking the attendance and are also experiencing joy in getting members connected through transfer. To pray for and encourage all the statistics incharges itself has been a wonderful part of my statistics journey. Here I can say that the zone statistics incharge has a lot of responsibility. *(Laughs!!)*

I have been applying this one guidance “Where there is unseen virtue, there will be visible reward”. Through my seniors, I have learnt to be proactive; whenever I have reached out to them, they have promptly responded and encouraged me. And I realise that it is the same encouragement I have been extending to all statistics incharges in my care.



How has being a statistics incharge helped you personally?

I work with operations department in a tech company and there are two aspects which I could develop from my statistics responsibility – sincerity and diligence. As a statistics incharge, we work behind the scenes and coordinate with so many people around us. We may even feel that our efforts are feeble but in reality, they create a huge impact on other lives and advance kosen-rufu. Our BSG IT team has been a pillar of this momentum, imparting sincerity, creativity and diligence. Whenever I coordinate with them, I learn so much. This has helped me to put that spirit in my work and continue to support at my workplace based on Sensei's guidance. Hence, being a statistics incharge, I have come to truly appreciate how our efforts greatly contribute to the growth of an organisation and economic development of the country and the world.



Please share your experience of working on BDS?

BDS is very convenient and user friendly even for those who are not tech savvy. Same for BSG Connect Plus mobile app as well.

Statistics incharges are still learning the BDS, but they proactively come forward to sort lists, pending graduations, transfers etc. They are taking the initiative. BDS is efficient and faster with the new features such as creating family, appointment module, Gohonzon module etc. which are quite empowering. Also, BDS has made things paperless which is aligned with SDG.

This new technology is truly empowering and supporting the new and old leadership.



Do you read the ABACUS regularly ? What do you think is the importance of ABACUS personally for you?

While I have missed many issues, but this year I started reading ABACUS with a fresh resolve to encourage my zone, the statistics incharges. Through ABACUS, I could see the efforts we were making one month after month. I saw our zone name in the 'Mathematicians of the Month' section for attendance marking and that filled me and all others in the zone with so much joy. This joy was so infectious that I see the statistics incharges taking the lead based on that one encouragement.

ABACUS has helped me understand what all I was missing on (*Laughs!!*).

I wish ABACUS could also be published in VC or VCT so that no one would miss out on reading ABACUS, and everyone could know about the efforts of statistics incharges.



What is your determination as statistics incharge towards 2030?

I am determined to have statistics incharges in each district of my zone, support them and help them achieve their full potential.

I am also determined to embrace all the lives who are getting transferred to my zone, cherish them and advance kosen-rufu towards 2030. Most importantly, I am so determined to read ABACUS regularly along with my statistics incharges. ★★



5 YEARS OF ABACUS AND THE PUZZLE – THANK YOU!

Your enthusiasm has kept our puzzle section alive and thriving.
Here's a quick look at our journey so far:



Puzzles published: 58



Responses received: 1,308



Consistency champions:



Shobha Dube from Delhi North has **participated 46 times**



Aruna Patra from West India 1 has **participated 45 times**



Anushka Harwani from North India and

Rina Iyer from West India 1 have **participated 41 times**

Here's to many more years of puzzling together starting with this special **August anniversary challenge!** 

Ikeda Sensei's guidance are treasures of courage and hope. In this activity, each quote begins in **Column A** and finds its completion in **Column B**.

Match them to find the complete guidance.

	Column A		Column B
1	Treasuring each individual	A	the important thing is how we challenge ourselves from now on.
2	The outcome of a struggle is	B	even though we may be struggling with problems ourselves, is the mark of bodhisattvas.
3	What makes us admirable as practitioners of Nichiren Buddhism	C	is the heart of the people-oriented philosophy, or humanism, of the Lotus Sutra.
4	Become the kind of leaders whom others regard as	D	hardships, eagerly awaits them, and then rises joyfully to challenge them.
5	The most important people	E	Not background, social position, or inherent abilities, but our tireless efforts to support our fellow members and help them become happy.

6	Striving to bring happiness and joy to others,	F	to value their fellow members to the highest degree and serve them sincerely.
7	However hard we may have exerted ourselves in the past,	G	decided by the leaders' determination, by their sense of responsibility.
8	The mentor-disciple relationship is the	H	a source of reassurance, clarity, peace of mind, and courage—people who inspire confidence and hope.
9	The fundamental attitude of Soka Gakkai leaders must always be	I	essence of Nichiren Buddhism and the heart of the Soka Gakkai spirit.
10	The votary of the Lotus Sutra welcomes	J	are those in our immediate environment right now.

Please send your answers at statistics@bharatsokagakkai.org by 31st August 2025

ANSWERS OF LAST MONTH'S PUZZLE

- | | | |
|---------------|---------------|------------|
| 1) Cherishing | 4) Statistics | 6) Mission |
| 2) Gratitude | 5) Great Vow | 7) Daimoku |
| 3) Membership | | |

LAST MONTH'S PUZZLE WINNERS

- | | |
|-----------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| ★ Avik Bhattacharya – South India | ★ Pooja Anand – Delhi North |
| ★ Jaya Chatterjee – East India | ★ Rina Iyer – West India 1 |
| ★ Meenakshi Khani – West India 2 | ★ Sonia Jhington – West India 1 |



BDS HELPDESK

In case of any query or assistance on BDS, please write to:
helpdesk@bharatsokagakkai.org
 or create a ticket on BDS under 'Ticket System'.



WE WANT YOUR FEEDBACK

We look forward to hearing from you! Please write to us if you have any feedback on the newsletter or if you wish to share your experience as statistics incharge; please mail us at :
statistics@bharatsokagakkai.org